Resilience Academy

SDI Training for ICT Professionals

KoboToolbox Administration

Users, Monitoring, Exports, and Backups

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Day 3 | 30 Minutes Lecture | crd.resilienceacademy.ac.tz

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User Management: Creating Accounts and Permissions

Creating User Accounts

As the admin, you control who can use the system.

1. Log in as the **admin** user
2. Go to **Settings** → **User Management** (admin panel)
3. Click **"Add User"**
4. Enter a username, email, and password
5. Click **Save**

Each user gets their own workspace where they can create and manage their own forms.

Form Permissions

Control who can see and submit to each form.

- Open a form → **Settings** tab → **Sharing**
- Add users by name or email
- Set permission levels:
  - **View form** – can see but not change
  - **Add submissions** – can collect data
  - **View submissions** – can see collected data
  - **Edit form** – can modify the form

Monitoring: Is KoboToolbox Running Properly?

Regular health checks keep your system reliable.

Check 1: Are all containers running?

- Open a terminal on the server
- Run: `docker compose ps`
- All containers should show status **"Up"** with green/healthy indicators
- If any container shows "Exit" or "Restarting", there may be a problem

Check 2: Can you access the web interface?

- Open a browser and go to your KoboToolbox URL
- The login page should load within a few seconds
- Log in and check that forms and data are visible

Check 3: Disk space

- Run: `df -h` to see how much disk space is available

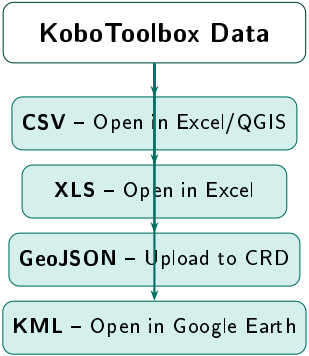
Data Export: CSV, Excel, and GeoJSON

Exporting Your Collected Data

KoboToolbox lets you download your data in several formats – all from the web interface, no commands needed.

How to export:

1. Open your form in KoboToolbox
2. Click the **"Data"** tab
3. Click **"Downloads"** in the left sidebar
4. Choose your format:
   - **CSV** – for spreadsheets and QGIS
   - **XLS** (Excel) – for analysis in Excel
   - **GeoJSON** – for GIS applications and CRD



For SDI Integration

CSV is the most versatile format. You will use it in Session 5 to bring data

Backup Basics: Protecting Your Data

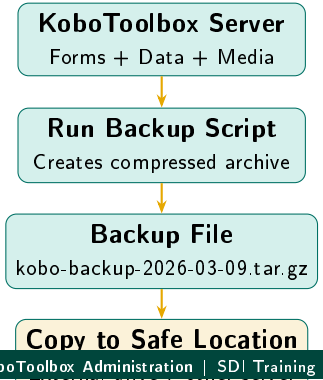
Why Back Up?

Your KoboToolbox server contains all your forms and all collected data. If the server fails and you have no backup, **everything is lost**. Regular backups are essential.

What gets backed up:

- All form designs
- All submitted data (answers, GPS, timestamps)
- All uploaded media (photos, audio)
- User accounts and permissions
- System configuration

How it works:



Updating KoboToolbox

Why Update?

Updates bring security fixes, bug fixes, and new features. Keep your installation current, especially for internet-facing servers.

The update process (overview):

1. **Back up first** – always before updating
2. **Pull new files** – download the latest version from GitHub
3. **Re-run setup** – the wizard detects existing settings
4. **Restart services** – Docker rebuilds containers with new code
5. **Verify** – log in and check that

Important rules:

- ✓ **Always back up** before updating
- ✓ **Read the release notes** – check if any special steps are needed
- ✓ **Test after updating** – log in, open a form, check data is intact
- × **Never update** during active data collection in the field
- × **Never skip major versions** – update

Administration Summary

User Management
Create accounts, set form permissions

Monitoring
docker compose ps, check web interface

Data Export
CSV, Excel, GeoJSON from the web interface

Backups
Run backup script weekly, copy to safe location

Your Weekly Admin Checklist

1. Check all containers are running (`docker compose ps`) — *2 minutes*
2. Log in to the web interface and verify forms are accessible — *1 minute*
3. Check disk space (`df -h`) — *1 minute*
4. Run the backup script and copy the backup file — *5 minutes*